

Color complexes survive piece trades

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

When a bishop is exchanged, the squares it defended do not disappear. Weaknesses on that color may become harder to protect. Before trading a bishop near your king, inspect pawn holes and possible enemy queen or knight entries.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If your dark-square pawns have advanced and your dark-squared bishop is traded, squares such as f3 or h3 may need new defenders. The problem depends on the exact pawn arrangement and enemy access, not on color terminology alone.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How can you compensate for losing a key bishop?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Trade the opponent's matching attacker, use other pieces to control entry squares, or alter the pawn structure safely. Sometimes exchanging queens removes the danger most directly.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

After a trade, ask who inherits the abandoned squares.